Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 4 3
♥ A K Q J
♦ A K
♣ A K Q 5 2

♠ J 10 8 6
♥ 9 7
♦ 10 8 3
♣ J 9 8 4

♠ 9
♥ 10 5 3 2
♦ Q J 9 6 4 2
♣ 10 7

♠ A K Q 7 5 2
♥ 8 6 4
♦ 7 5
♣ 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

7NT by North
Lead: ♦Q

West follows twice, then discards 2 ♦s.

Don't play ♠s yet!

Play your ♦A. West must give up.

If he throws the ♣J, you win. But if he throws a ♠ you also win. This is what is called a Win-Win bridge play.

South's 3NT rebid shows 6 ♠s headed by A K Q and nothing else. North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♦Q.

Nice hand. You have 12 high card tricks and either a 3-2 ♠ split or a 3-3 ♣ split will land this Grand Slam. But even if neither suit splits nicely you can STILL make it if the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits; in that case you will squeeze for the thirteenth trick.

You win the ♦K.

Win the ♦K and (**IMPORTANT!**) test the ♣s first by playing ♣ A K Q. Darn. East discards a ♦ on the ♣Q.

Alright, so West holds the ♣ Guard. You still need to exercise caution.

Play your 4 ♥ winner's next. East follows suit while

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 9 7 4 2
♥ J 4
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ 9 5 2

♠ 10 6
♥ A K 8 6
♦ 9 7 3
♣ A K Q J

♠ A K Q J
♥ 9 5 3
♦ K Q
♣ 10 8 7 4

♠ 8 5 3
♥ Q 10 7 2
♦ J 10 8 4
♣ 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	Pass	1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♦J

East is to play 6NT. South leads the ♦J. North takes the ♦A and returns the ♦2.

Your 4 ♠ tricks, 2 ♥ tricks, 1 ♦ trick and 4 ♣ tricks are very easy to find. But that's only 11, so where in the world can you possibly find number 12?

With all those high ♦s falling on the first two tricks dummy's ♦ 9 has become a threat against South. If it should happen that South also holds the only ♥ stopper you can squeeze him in the red suits.

You are going to run your black suit winners, taking the ♣s first so you can be playing winners from your hand when you squeeze South.

On the last 2 ♣s South discards a ♦ and a ♥.

Now come to your hand with the ♠A and play the ♠ K Q.

You discard a small ♥ from dummy while South follows suit three times.

It is time.

South discards the ♥7, holding on to the ♦10.

Play your ♠J and watch what South discards.

If he holds on to the ♦10 you will discard dummy's useless ♦9 and hope the ♥s all fall under the ♥ A K.

If he discards the ♦10 then you throw dummy's small ♥ and dummy wins the last three tricks.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K Q 5 ♥ 7 5 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ A 10 7 5	
♠ 7 4 2 ♥ J 10 9 6 3 ♦ 8 6 4 ♣ J 6	N W E S	♠ J 10 8 6 ♥ A 8 4 2 ♦ 5 ♣ K 9 4 2
	♠ 9 3 ♥ K Q ♦ A K Q J 9 3 ♣ Q 8 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6NT by South
Lead: ♥J

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♥J. East wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

West plays low.

The solution is the Vienna Coup: a ♣ to the ♣A at trick 3.

Then start running the ♦ suit.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

West discards.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

East is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ Q J 10 6 4 ♥ 10 ♦ 10 9 7 4 2 ♣ 8 2	
♠ K 7 ♥ A Q J 7 5 2 ♦ J 5 ♣ 7 6 4		♠ 9 3 ♥ K 9 8 6 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ A K Q 5
	♠ A 8 5 2 ♥ 4 ♦ K Q 8 3 ♣ J 10 9 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♠Q

Play 5 ♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

North discards.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

South has no answer.

West is to play 6♥. North leads the ♠Q. South wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

South's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against South. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.